

ZUCCHINI, MARROW SQUASHES, AND SUMMER SQUASHES *Cucurbita pepo*

Fast and easy to grow, these reliable vegetables are prolific croppers. Not all types are long and green—they come in a range of colors and unusual shapes, many of which are highly decorative. Although all types will grow to marrow squash size, harvest zucchini and squashes when small.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Zucchini, summer squashes, and marrow squashes all do best in a sunny, open site, with rich, well-drained soil. Dig in some well-rotted manure or compost before sowing or planting.

Seed can be sown from mid-spring onward: if sowing early, do so in a greenhouse or under cover. Later seed can be sown in pots or in the ground but will need protection with a cloche or cold frame. Sow seed 18 in (45 cm) apart, and 1 in (2.5 cm) deep.

CROP CARE

Developing fruits need regular watering and should not be allowed to dry out, especially when they are flowering, or while the fruits are swelling. They may



It may help to pollinate by hand.

benefit from an application of general fertilizer during growth.

If you are growing under glass, your crops may lack insect pollinators so you may need to pollinate them by hand. Identify a female flower, one that has the thickened stem of the developing fruit, and transfer pollen from a male flower's stamens onto the stigma, by touching the flowers together.